LASHONDA GRAHAM

Healthcare Operations & Analytics Manager

Compliance & Governance | Executive Reporting & KPI Analytics | Program Leadership | Revenue-Cycle Readiness
Dallas-Fort Worth, TX | 501-817-6362 | lashondag01@gmail.com | linkedin.com/in/lashondag | lashondag01.github.io/LGPortfolio

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Benefits and healthcare operations professional with 13+ years across benefits support, behavioral health operations, and enterprise IT, backed by an M.S. in Business Analytics. Currently resolves health & welfare and pension inquiries at Willis Towers Watson, interpreting plan provisions and researching complex cases across multiple systems. Brings hands-on carrier and payer experience, including eligibility and benefits verification, authorizations, and enrollment with BCBS, UnitedHealthcare, Ambetter, and Medicaid. Known for spotting recurring issues and fixing them at the source: cut open audit findings about 75% (80+ to ~20) and built the documentation and training that help teams get it right the first time.

SELECTED ACCOMPLISHMENTS

- **Audit & compliance turnaround:** Reduced open audit findings about 75% (80+ to ~20) in 6 months by leading root-cause analysis, SOP redesign, and corrective-action governance with the clinical director and outsourced compliance officer.
- **First executive reporting function:** Built 5 KPI dashboards from scratch tracking admissions, utilization, client outcomes, payer mix, and revenue, giving leadership and the board on-demand performance visibility for the first time.
- **Enterprise system implementation:** Led a six-month Kipu EMR and Relias LMS implementation from business need through stabilization, cleaning and validating legacy data, running 15–20 UAT scenarios, and training 20 staff for an on-time go-live with Clinical Director sign-off.
- **Strategic planning for a new practice:** Built the CARF accreditation roadmap, Strategic Plan (2026–2029), and break-even feasibility model that guide a behavioral health founding team's staffing, location, and launch decisions.

CORE SKILLS

Leadership & Strategy: Healthcare operations management, program governance, strategic and business planning, executive partnership, cross-functional leadership, change management, influencing without authority, staff supervision

Compliance & Risk: Regulatory compliance, audit preparedness, corrective-action tracking, root-cause analysis, policy and procedure development, HIPAA, 42 CFR Part 2, Joint Commission standards, CARF accreditation planning, Arkansas licensure standards (OADAP), SOX controls

Analytics & Executive Reporting: KPI dashboard design, executive and board reporting, financial and operational analysis, feasibility and break-even modeling, variance and trend analysis, data validation, executive recommendations

Revenue Cycle & Payer Operations: Provider credentialing and payer enrollment (CAQH, NPPES, PECOS, Availity), Medicaid/MCO enrollment, payer contract amendments, insurance verification and authorization, claims submission and revenue monitoring, revenue-cycle readiness

Program & Delivery Management: Requirements elicitation, UAT, implementation and go-live, vendor evaluation and management, risk and issue management, Agile/Scrum, Waterfall, hybrid delivery

Data, Systems & Tools: Advanced Excel, Power BI (Power Query), SQL Server, Google Sheets, Google Apps Script, Kipu EMR, Relias LMS, Microsoft 365 (Excel, Word, Outlook, PowerPoint), Microsoft Project, Salesforce CRM, Oracle CRM, Workfront, Trello; ChatGPT and Claude with human review of all output

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Business Support Assistant, Customer Service Representative 1 | Willis Towers Watson **08/2025–Present**

Global advisory, broking, and solutions company | Health & welfare and pension benefits administration

- Assist employees, retirees, and plan participants with benefits, eligibility, pension, enrollment, and life-event inquiries by phone, email, and chat.
- Interpret plan provisions, policies, and procedures to provide accurate guidance and resolve participant concerns.
- Research complex issues across multiple systems and databases, document findings in detailed case notes, and coordinate appropriate resolution.
- Maintain accuracy and HIPAA compliance while handling confidential participant and benefits information.
- Manage competing priorities in a high-volume environment while meeting quality, productivity, and service-level expectations.
- Identify recurring participant concerns and workflow issues that may require escalation or process clarification.
- Collaborate with team members and internal resources to resolve cases and provide consistent participant experience.

Business Operations & Compliance Manager | Freshly Renewed Transitional **01/2024–08/2025**

Outpatient substance use treatment provider (OP, IOP, PHP) | Single site, ~25 employees

- Reduced open audit findings about 75% (80+ to ~20) over 6 months: owned site compliance against Joint Commission and

Arkansas licensure standards, led root-cause analysis of state licensing, accreditation, and Medicaid/payer findings with the clinical director and outsourced compliance officer, and redesigned SOPs and corrective-action workflows.

- Built the organization's first centralized reporting: 5 KPI dashboards in Excel, Power BI, and Google Sheets tracking admissions, utilization, payer mix, length of stay, completion rates, readmissions, discharge reasons, and client satisfaction, with demographic breakdowns and executive- and board-level reports available on demand.
- Led the Kipu EMR and Relias LMS implementation (08/2024–02/2025) end to end: defined configuration requirements, cleaned and validated the legacy data export for import, ran 15–20 cross-functional UAT scenarios, trained 20 current and new-hire staff, and delivered an on-time go-live with Clinical Director sign-off and post-launch stabilization.
- Managed provider recredentialing, payer enrollment with UnitedHealthcare, Lucet, and other commercial and Medicaid payers (CAQH, NPPES, PECOS, Availity), and Medicaid affiliations across clinical and administrative teams to maintain revenue-cycle readiness.
- Supported budget planning with leadership and monitored claims submission and revenue in partnership with the contracted billing specialist.
- Supervised 4–5 administrative staff across credentialing, payer enrollment, insurance verification and authorization, intake, and payroll coordination; as HR generalist, owned the full new-hire process (~10 hires) and tracked employee satisfaction survey results to monitor staff morale.
- Replaced manual, as-needed tracking with automated Google Apps Script workflows for weekly client coverage-date alerts, weekly client testing, and monthly staff PTO updates, saving about 3–5 staff hours per week across the team.
- Led vendor evaluation and company-wide migration of ~20 users from Bluehost to Microsoft 365, presenting findings and a recommendation to the CEO for final decision.

Business Operations & Systems Consultant | Inspire Therapeutic Services, LLC **12/2022–Present**

Outpatient behavioral health and substance use treatment practice, Arkansas | Contract, as needed

- Established the governance framework the founding team uses to track priorities and decisions: 12-month CARF accreditation roadmap, Business Plan, Strategic Plan (2026–2029), and Planning Charter.
- Built a financial feasibility model from Arkansas Medicaid and in-network carrier reimbursement rates to set break-even session volume, informing budgeting, staffing, and location planning.
- Led payer enrollment with Arkansas Medicaid, Arkansas BCBS, Ambetter, UnitedHealthcare, and Lucet, plus provider credentialing (CAQH, NPPES, PECOS, Availity) and Medicaid affiliation, to establish revenue-cycle readiness for the new practice.
- Monitor claims submission and revenue in partnership with the contracted billing specialist.
- Authored Arkansas-specific policies and procedures covering OADAP licensure, BHA certification, 42 CFR Part 2, HIPAA, and Medicaid/MCO enrollment, plus client-facing privacy forms and emergency and safety protocols.
- Mapped and standardized clinical intake workflows and administrative controls, and designed Google Sheets dashboards tracking census, session volume, referrals, payer mix, capacity, and revenue.

Campaign Specialist | Vestcom, an Avery Dennison Company **01/2021–05/2023**

Client implementation and project delivery for a shelf-edge media and marketing services provider to retailers and CPG brands

- Achieved ~95% on-time store activation across 5–6 concurrent retail campaigns, each deployed to every store in a national grocery retailer's regional division (one-day events to 5–6 week holiday programs), coordinating Sales, Corporate IT, Programming, Production, and Creative Operations in a matrixed delivery model.
- Owned pre-deployment quality control for creative assets, auditing artwork with external brand representatives for brand compliance and with IT for coding defects. Caught issues in ~5% of assets before they reached stores.
- Diagnosed root causes of late or incorrect activations (backend IT defects vs. store-level processing delays) and partnered with IT and internal stakeholders on fixes.
- Tracked timelines, dependencies, and risks in Trello using Agile-informed practices and reported status across teams; worked in Oracle CRM and Salesforce CRM.

IT Analyst | Vestcom, an Avery Dennison Company **06/2012–01/2021**

Production issue resolution, business systems analysis, and UAT

- Served as business systems liaison among corporate stakeholders, operations, developers, and technical support, authoring business requirements, functional documentation, test plans, user stories, and process maps for an average of 6–7 production releases per year.
- Led user acceptance testing and release validation, partnered on regression testing, and maintained traceability to business requirements documents (BRDs) so releases matched documented scope before sign-off.
- Supported SOX-controlled processes by maintaining documentation, validating system controls, and confirming required testing and approvals.
- Resolved client-reported production issues (pricing errors, tags not received, artwork problems) through SQL Server analysis and code research, routing confirmed defects to Programming and Creative and identifying client-supplied data causes.

EDUCATION

Master of Science, Applied Digital Technology – Business Analytics | Arkansas State University | 2025
Bachelor of Business Administration, Management Information Systems | University of Arkansas at Little Rock | 2012